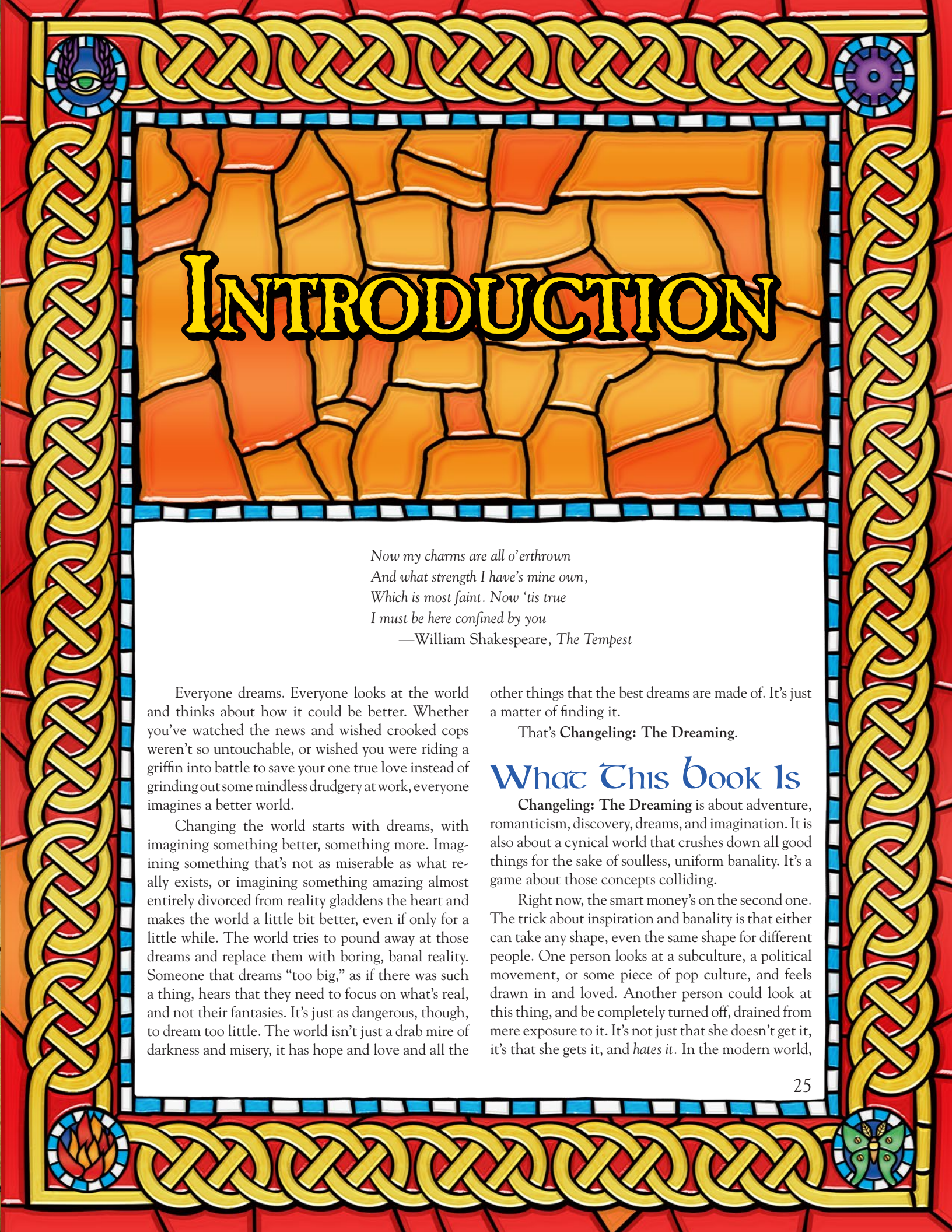




INTRODUCTION

*Now my charms are all o'erthrown
And what strength I have's mine own,
Which is most faint. Now 'tis true
I must be here confined by you*
—William Shakespeare, *The Tempest*

Everyone dreams. Everyone looks at the world and thinks about how it could be better. Whether you've watched the news and wished crooked cops weren't so untouchable, or wished you were riding a griffin into battle to save your one true love instead of grinding out some mindless drudgery at work, everyone imagines a better world.

Changing the world starts with dreams, with imagining something better, something more. Imagining something that's not as miserable as what really exists, or imagining something amazing almost entirely divorced from reality gladdens the heart and makes the world a little bit better, even if only for a little while. The world tries to pound away at those dreams and replace them with boring, banal reality. Someone that dreams "too big," as if there was such a thing, hears that they need to focus on what's real, and not their fantasies. It's just as dangerous, though, to dream too little. The world isn't just a drab mire of darkness and misery, it has hope and love and all the

other things that the best dreams are made of. It's just a matter of finding it.

That's **Changeling: The Dreaming**.

What This Book Is

Changeling: The Dreaming is about adventure, romanticism, discovery, dreams, and imagination. It is also about a cynical world that crushes down all good things for the sake of soulless, uniform banality. It's a game about those concepts colliding.

Right now, the smart money's on the second one. The trick about inspiration and banality is that either can take any shape, even the same shape for different people. One person looks at a subculture, a political movement, or some piece of pop culture, and feels drawn in and loved. Another person could look at this thing, and be completely turned off, drained from mere exposure to it. It's not just that she doesn't get it, it's that she gets it, and *hates it*. In the modern world,